

Matchbook Learning — Culture & Student Support Playbook

Director of Student Support and Culture | K-8 School

Effective: School Year 2026–2027 | Living Document — Review Annually

North Star: This role is not discipline-driven. It is systems-driven, relationship-driven, and prevention-focused. The Director of Student Support and Culture exists to remove barriers to learning — ensuring every student has the behavioral, social-emotional, attendance, safety, and family supports necessary to remain engaged in instruction and thrive at Matchbook Learning.

How to Use This Playbook

This playbook is organized the way the work actually flows — from your daily operational rhythm outward to the systems that govern each domain. Every section tells you:

- What the system is and why it exists
- Who owns what — you, the Dean, counselors, staff, district contacts
- What triggers action — the specific indicators that move a student into support
- What the steps are — in sequence, with no gaps
- How to document it — so nothing falls through the cracks
- What the recurring calendar looks like — so you stay ahead instead of reactive

Use it as a reference, a training tool for your team, and a compliance anchor. When a new situation arises, find the closest protocol, follow it, and note what needs to be added to the next version.

Part One: Role Architecture

1.1 Director of Student Support and Culture — Who You Are

The Director of Student Support and Culture is the systems architect and people champion for every student who needs more than the classroom can give. You sit at the intersection of:

- Behavior and culture — MTSS, DBRCs, restorative practices, behavior contracts, re-entry
- Attendance and family — chronic absenteeism, home visits, outreach protocols
- Safety and compliance — threat assessments, safety plans, Title IX, DCS, crisis response
- Special populations — McKinney-Vento, Foster Care, BrightLane, Aspire

- **Student wellness** — counselor collaboration, mental health referrals, suicide ideation follow-up
- **Team leadership** — directly supporting counselors, Dean, mentors, restorative staff, front office

You do not handle discipline alone. You build and protect the systems that prevent, respond to, and restore from discipline. When systems work, fewer students need intensive intervention.

1.2 Your Core Team and Partners

Person / Role	Scope	Key Contact
Dean	Tier 2 DBRC creation, ISS/OSS data, daily behavior response	Internal
K-4 School Counselor	Small groups, parent communication, student wellness, DCS	Internal
5-8 School Counselor	High school transition, 21st Century Scholars, DCS, threat assessments	Internal
Restorative Team Mentors	Daily DBRC check-ins, Tier 2/3 dashboard updates, restorative visits	Internal
Family Services Coordinator	Community resource connection, family engagement, McKinney-Vento support	Mr. Ornelas (Internal)
Social Worker	McKinney-Vento identification and documentation, student stability	Katie Nelson (Internal)
District McKinney-Vento Liaison	Eligibility, transportation, compliance oversight	Natalia Ramos — nramos@matchbooklearning.com
Aspire Indiana	Behavior planning, counseling services (Tier 3)	Mike Parks — michael.parks@aspireindiana.org
IPS Police	Threat assessments, safety concerns, criminal allegations	Assigned officer — school contact list
Emergent Tree	Universal Screener, DBRC platform, Tier 2 resources	Megan Flynn — megan@emergenttree.com

1.3 Systems Map — How Everything Connects

All work flows through four interdependent systems:

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PREVENTION (Tier 1 Culture)
  ↓
EARLY INTERVENTION (Tier 2 – DBRC, Mentor, Attendance Outreach)
  ↓
INTENSIVE SUPPORT (Tier 3 – Contracts, Safety Plans, Aspire, Attendance Agreements)
  ↓
COMPLIANCE & SPECIAL POPULATIONS (Title IX, DCS, McKinney-Vento, Foster Care, Expuls:

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No system operates in isolation. Attendance concerns trigger wellness checks. Behavior patterns surface DCS questions. Housing instability connects to McKinney-Vento. Your job is to

hold all four layers simultaneously.

Part Two: Daily and Weekly Operating Rhythm

2.1 Daily Schedule Framework

Your day is structured around prevention, not reaction. The following framework is your default; real life will adjust it, but this is the anchor.

Time Block	Focus	Key Actions
6:30–7:15 AM	Preparation & Review	Check email for overnight concerns; review ParentSquare; pull attendance concerns; check calendar; confirm counselor schedules; review dashboard for flagged students
7:15–8:00 AM	Arrival & Climate	Visible presence at arrival; greet students; observe emotional regulation; redirect escalating behavior; counselor referrals; mentor pairing. Goal: prevent discipline before it occurs
8:00–10:00 AM	High-Leverage Support Block	Most unpredictable block. Classroom removals, restorative conversations, de-escalation, parent contact, threat assessments, safety planning. Workflow: Teacher Concern → Classroom Intervention → Restorative Support → Tier Review → Family Communication → Documentation
10:00–11:00 AM	Attendance Systems	Review daily absence data; verify outreach occurred; identify trends; determine if absence is willful or barrier-based; support attendance clerk; make targeted parent contacts
11:00 AM–12:00 PM	Meetings & Coordination	MTSS meetings, student support meetings, parent conferences, counselor check-ins, restorative review, community partner meetings. Every meeting ends with clear action items, assigned ownership, and follow-up dates
12:00–1:00 PM	Lunch Supervision	Active presence. Observe peer dynamics; monitor for isolation, conflict patterns, boundary concerns, regulation issues. This is relationship-building time, not break time
1:00–2:30 PM	Investigations & Compliance	Title IX intake, witness interviews, student statements, family communication, documentation. Standard approach: gather facts → remain neutral → apply policy → document objectively → determine supports
2:30–3:30 PM	Tier III Data Review	Review DBRC trends, restorative room data, ISS/OSS, counselor notes, intervention outcomes. Decision questions: Continue? Intensify? Fade? Return to Tier 2? Output: student snapshots, leadership summaries, action plans
3:30–4:30 PM	Family Communication & Staff Support	Parent follow-up, teacher coaching, student plans, counselor collaboration. Tone: warm but direct, timely, solutions-oriented
4:30–5:30 PM	Strategic Planning	Systems work, data review, meeting prep, staff support planning. Questions: What barriers emerged? What needs redesign? What prevents recurrence?

2.2 Weekly Standing Responsibilities

Day	Standing Focus
Monday	Attendance review; student support prioritization; counselor alignment; confirm all mentor dashboard updates (due by 3:00 PM)
Tuesday	MTSS team / culture meeting (DBRC data review, tier decisions, restorative data)
Wednesday	Investigations and compliance catch-up; parent communication sweep
Thursday	Community partner coordination; McKinney-Vento/Foster Care/Aspire updates
Friday	End-of-week data review; prepare following week priorities; documentation audit

2.3 Monthly and Quarterly Commitments

Frequency	Commitment
Monthly	Community resource event (goal: establish one per month for families)
Monthly	Title IX documentation review
Quarterly	McKinney-Vento coordination meeting (District Liaison + Social Worker + Family Services Coordinator)
Twice annually (Sept & Jan)	Emergent Tree Universal Behavior Screener administration
Annually	Full SOP review; tracker maintenance; resource updates; staff training; end-of-year documentation audit

Part Three: Behavior MTSS System

3.1 System Purpose and Guiding Principles

The Behavior MTSS framework is Matchbook's structured continuum for identifying, supporting, and monitoring students with behavioral needs. The system is:

- **Preventative** — Tier 1 must be fully implemented before escalation
- **Restorative** — consequences are paired with skill-building and relationships
- **Data-driven** — tier decisions are made by teams using documented trends, not individual incidents
- **Family-partnered** — parent communication and meetings are required at every tier

Critical rule: A tier is only complete when it is documented. An undocumented intervention is not an intervention.

3.2 Tier 1 — Universal Behavior Supports (All Students)

Purpose: Establish a strong, predictable schoolwide culture that supports safe, respectful, and responsible behavior through explicit teaching and consistent reinforcement.

Review Cycle: 4 weeks of documented implementation before Tier 2 consideration, unless special entry criteria apply.

Required Before Any Tier 2 Consideration (Tier 1 Gatekeeper Checklist):

- ☐ Explicit teaching and reinforcement of schoolwide behavior expectations documented
- ☐ Consistent classroom redirection attempted and documented (verbal reminders, proximity, response hierarchy)
- ☐ Classroom-based interventions documented in PowerSchool
- ☐ Restorative room use tracked (if applicable)
- ☐ Teacher-initiated parent contact documented (message, phone call, or meeting)
- ☐ Tier 1 Behavior Tracker completed (if applicable)

Gatekeeper: Lanea Garrett reviews Tier 1 documentation and verifies checklist completion. Administrative sign-off required before Tier 2 escalation. If any step is missing or undocumented, Tier 1 is **incomplete** and escalation cannot proceed.

Data Tools:

- PowerSchool behavior logs
- Restorative room documentation
- ParentSquare or phone/email contact logs
- Parent meeting notes (brief, objective only)
- Emergent Tree Universal Behavior Screener (September and January)

Team Responsibilities:

Role	Responsibility
Principal	Oversees Tier 1 implementation and consistency
Teachers	Implement Tier 1 supports, document all data
Restorative Team	Provide restorative interventions, track visits

3.3 Tier 2 — Targeted Behavior Supports

Purpose: Provide structured, targeted support for students who do not respond to Tier 1 interventions with fidelity.

Review Cycle: 6 weeks of implementation before formal team review and tier decision.

Entry Criteria (all must be met):

- All Tier 1 checklist components completed and verified
- Adequate Tier 1 data documented
- Parent meeting occurred to build partnership and review concerns
- Teacher-initiated parent contact and meeting documented
- Student continues to demonstrate behavioral needs despite Tier 1 supports

Tier 2 Supports:

- Daily Behavior Report Card (DBRC) — implemented for 6 weeks minimum
- Assigned restorative team mentor with daily check-ins
- Weekly data review by MTSS team
- Targeted skill support if needed (additional 6–8 weeks)

Important: A parent meeting must occur **prior** to initiating a DBRC. DBRCs are not default escalation tools and may not be used as a shortcut to Tier 2.

Tier 2 Team Responsibilities:

Role	Responsibility
Dean	Creates the DBRC; assigns restorative mentor; reviews data weekly; monitors responsiveness
Restorative Team Mentor	Conducts daily check-ins; reinforces skills; documents interactions; updates Tier 2 Dashboard by 3:00 PM every Monday

Exit Criteria (Return to Tier 1):

- Student averages a 4 on the DBRC consistently for 6–8 weeks

Escalation to Tier 3 Criteria:

- Student does not average a 4 after 6–8 weeks of Tier 2 supports
- Parent meeting occurs to review data and next steps
- Decision made by MTSS team — not an individual

3.4 Tier 3 — Intensive Behavior Supports

Purpose: Provide individualized, intensive behavior supports for students with ongoing, significant behavioral, attendance, social-emotional, or safety concerns.

Review Cycle: 6 weeks of implementation before formal team review and adjustment.

Tier 3 Interventions:

- Continued DBRC (with added skills component)
- Behavior Contract or Critical Behavior Contract
- Aspire behavior planning and counseling
- Individualized Behavior Support Plan (BSP)

- Behavior Intervention Plan (BIP) — if warranted
- Functional Behavior Assessment (FBA) — only after Tier 1 and Tier 2 fidelity demonstrated
- Safety Plans (when safety is a factor)
- Attendance Success Agreements (if attendance is linked)

Special Education Collaboration: The Director participates in behavior-related Manifestation Determination Reviews (MDRs), Annual Case Reviews (ACRs), and Move-In Meetings for students with IEPs. Participation is limited to behavioral concerns and interventions.

FBA / 504 / Special Education Referral: Considered only after Tier 1 and Tier 2 fidelity is clearly documented. This is a team decision, not an administrative one.

3.5 DBRC System Operations

What a DBRC Is: An evidence-based progress monitoring tool providing students with frequent feedback on behavioral expectations throughout the school day. Managed through the Emergent Tree platform.

DBRC Goal Framework:

- Goals must be observable, measurable, and positively stated
- Aligned to school expectations: Safe | Respectful | Responsible
- Individualized based on student needs

Daily DBRC Workflow:

1. Teacher provides behavioral feedback and rating at the end of each instructional period
2. Brief teacher-student conference whenever possible (review performance, reinforce strengths, prepare for next period)
3. If teacher cannot conference: complete hard-copy DBRC form with accurate ratings for mentor review
4. Teacher submits electronic DBRC data in Emergent Tree **before leaving the building each day**
5. Mentor reviews daily performance with assigned student
6. Mentor updates Tier 2/3 Dashboard by 3:00 PM **every Monday**
7. Dean enters ISS/OSS data into both Tier 2 and Tier 3 Dashboards

DBRC Dashboard: <https://progress.emergenttree.com/matchbookcampus-2ec5bbe8a77b232f1bd84a0e50fc23d7/students/report>

Mentor Assignment Guidelines:

- Students and parents may select a mentor when possible (increases buy-in)
- Mentors drawn from: Restorative Team, Related Arts Teachers, Non-Classroom Staff, approved school personnel

- Students with the most intensive needs or limited parent support → assigned to Dean or Director

3.6 In-School Suspension (ISS) Protocol

Purpose: Provide accountability while maintaining student access to instruction.

ISS Time Guidelines by Grade:

Grade	Maximum ISS Duration
K-2	1.5 hours maximum
Grade 3	2 hours maximum
Grades 4-8	Half-day maximum

ISS Time Blocks: 7:45–10:45 AM or 11:00 AM–2:00 PM

Community Service Component: Students in ISS should participate in restorative community service whenever appropriate (assisting during K-2 lunch, supporting cafeteria operations, school-based service opportunities).

3.7 Behavior Contracts and Re-Entry

Behavior Contract — used when a student requires explicit, written expectations with parent partnership. Facilitated by the Director.

Critical Behavior Contract — used for students at highest risk of expulsion or removal. Involves administration, parent, and the student in a structured agreement with defined consequences and support plan.

Re-Entry Planning (after OSS or extended absence):

1. Director reviews the incident and student status before return
2. Re-entry meeting with student — review expectations, safety, and support plan
3. Parent communication prior to return
4. Notify mentor and teachers of student's return and any updated plan
5. First-day check-in scheduled with mentor
6. Document re-entry meeting in PowerSchool within 24 hours

Part Four: Attendance System

4.1 Purpose and Framing

Attendance is not just compliance — it is a wellness indicator. Every absence is a data point. The question behind every absence is: **Is this willful or barrier-based?** That question determines the intervention.

Chronic absenteeism is defined as missing 10% or more of school days. Early identification and warm outreach prevent the need for formal intervention.

4.2 Attendance Monitoring Protocol

Daily Actions:

- Pull absence report each morning by 10:00 AM
- Review attendance trends — identify students hitting or approaching thresholds
- Verify outreach occurred for flagged students
- Identify potential barriers: transportation, housing instability, McKinney-Vento, illness patterns, family concerns

4.3 Attendance Intervention Ladder

The following steps are sequential. Each step must be documented in PowerSchool before escalation to the next level.

Threshold	Intervention	Owner	Documentation
5 days absent	Letter sent home	Attendance clerk / Director	PowerSchool log
7 days absent	Email home + ParentSquare message	Director	PowerSchool log + ParentSquare record
7–8 days absent	Parent phone call from Director	Director	PowerSchool log with call summary
9–10 days absent	Parent home visit coordinated	Director + counselor	Home visit log in PowerSchool
10+ days absent	Certified letter sent home	Director	Copy retained in file
Ongoing / No response	DCS referral for educational neglect (if warranted)	School Counselor (with Director support)	DCS documentation

At every step ask: Is this absence willful or barrier-based? Transportation barriers and housing instability route to McKinney-Vento. Medical concerns route to wellness support. Willful avoidance routes to the MTSS behavior framework.

4.4 Attendance Success Agreements

Attendance Success Agreements are formal written commitments used when a family has been engaged through the intervention ladder without adequate improvement. They are:

- Developed collaboratively with the family
- Signed by the student (when age-appropriate), guardian, and Director

- Reviewed at a set interval (typically 4 weeks)
- Documented in PowerSchool
- Linked to identified barriers and specific support commitments from the school

4.5 DCS Referral — Educational Neglect

When attendance intervention has been exhausted and a student's absence constitutes educational neglect, the school counselor leads the DCS report. The Director supports by:

- Confirming the intervention ladder was completed and documented
- Providing attendance data and documentation to the counselor
- Coordinating follow-up communication
- Documenting outcomes in PowerSchool when DCS dispositions are shared (Assessed / Screened Out)

All DCS referrals are led by school counselors. The Director coordinates, does not independently file.

Part Five: Student Wellness and Safety

5.1 Threat Assessment Protocol

When It Applies: Any student who makes a statement, gesture, or takes an action that could indicate potential harm to self or others.

Threat Assessment Team:

- Director of Student Support and Culture (coordinator)
- School Counselor(s)
- Dean
- IPS Police (when warranted)
- Head of School or Assistant Principal

Process:

1. Incident reported to Director and/or counselor immediately
2. Remove student from general population to a supervised, calm space
3. Gather initial facts — do not interrogate; use calm, open-ended questions
4. Convene threat assessment team (same day if possible)
5. Complete Threat Assessment documentation (see Title IX / Safety folder)
6. Determine level of threat: low / moderate / high
7. Notify parent/guardian — document all communication
8. Develop Safety Plan if warranted

9. Coordinate with IPS Police if threat level requires it
10. Document fully in PowerSchool within 24 hours
11. Schedule follow-up check-in within 1 week

5.2 Safety Plans

A Safety Plan is a written agreement developed with the student (and parent) identifying:

- Triggers and early warning signs
- Coping strategies and trusted adults at school
- Emergency contacts and procedures
- Monitoring schedule
- Conditions for re-entry or escalated support

Safety Plans are created after threat assessments, suicide ideation screenings, or any event indicating a student may be at risk of harming themselves or others. They are stored in the confidential student file and referenced at re-entry.

5.3 Suicide Ideation Protocol

1. Any staff member who hears or suspects suicidal ideation → immediately notify school counselor and Director
2. Do not leave student alone
3. School counselor conducts screening (Columbia Protocol or school-approved tool)
4. Director coordinates with parent/guardian — same day notification required
5. If imminent risk → call 911; IPS Police contacted
6. Safety Plan developed prior to student's return to school
7. Re-entry meeting required before student returns
8. Document in PowerSchool within 24 hours; maintain confidentiality per school procedures

5.4 DCS Reporting Protocol

Who Reports: Any employee who suspects abuse or neglect should immediately notify a school counselor. The counselor makes the formal DCS report. Teachers may collaborate with the counselor on the report when time permits. **Student safety always takes priority.**

School Counselor Responsibilities:

- Making formal DCS reports
- Maintaining documentation
- Coordinating follow-up communication
- Communicating with appropriate school personnel

Director's Role: Coordinate and support, not lead. If multiple reports must be filed simultaneously, the Director supports the counselor. When DCS dispositions are received (Assessed / Screened Out), share with: Director, Assistant Principal, and School Counselors. Document in PowerSchool.

Documentation Timeline: Within 24 hours of the event for all significant communications, reports, and outcomes.

5.5 BrightLane Check-In System

BrightLane is a structured check-in tool for students receiving social-emotional monitoring and support. The Director:

- Oversees student identification for BrightLane enrollment
- Ensures regular check-ins are occurring and documented
- Reviews BrightLane data as part of weekly student wellness review
- Coordinates with counselors on student progress and escalation

Part Six: Title IX

6.1 Role

The Director of Student Support and Culture serves as the **Title IX Coordinator** for Matchbook Learning. This means all Title IX complaints are routed through you, and you are responsible for procedural compliance, documentation integrity, and outcome communication.

6.2 Title IX Investigation Process

Step 1 – Intake

- Receive complaint (written or verbal)
- Document intake immediately: date, reporter, nature of complaint, parties involved
- Notify Head of School
- Determine if complaint triggers formal investigation

Step 2 – Investigation

- Notify parties (complainant and respondent) of the process and their rights
- Gather witness statements (interviews conducted neutrally, one witness at a time)
- Collect supporting documentation
- Remain neutral throughout – apply the facts, not judgment

Step 3 – Documentation

- Maintain an investigation report for every case (use Investigation Report Template from Title IX folder)

- Document all communications — parent letters, interviews, findings
- Ensure record retention requirements are met

Step 4 — Outcome

- Draft outcome letter for all parties
- Communicate supports and next steps
- Identify any safety measures needed for impacted students
- Document resolution in Title IX Tracker

Title IX Folder (Google Drive): <https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1UIdZt08EoTuFc88Tv0KPr0K3ARQXaM4>

Documentation: Every step must be documented. Title IX investigations with incomplete records create compliance exposure. If it is not documented, it did not happen.

Part Seven: Expulsion and Alternative Placement

7.1 When Expulsion Is Considered

Expulsion is a last resort. It is considered when:

- A student's behavior poses a significant and ongoing safety risk that cannot be managed through MTSS
- Critical Behavior Contracts have been exhausted without progress
- Behavior constitutes a violation requiring mandatory expulsion consideration under IPS policy or Indiana law

7.2 Expulsion Process

1. Director reviews all MTSS documentation to confirm interventions were implemented with fidelity
2. Head of School notified and in agreement to pursue expulsion proceedings
3. Parent/guardian notified in writing of the intent to expel and their rights to a hearing
4. Expulsion committee convened — documentation presented
5. Partnership with Options Program coordinated for Temporary Remote Instruction (as applicable, post-Spring Break protocol)
6. Director maintains all documentation: parent letters, committee notes, hearing records, outcomes
7. If student has an IEP: Manifestation Determination Review (MDR) must occur before any expulsion can proceed — Director participates in behavioral portion

7.3 Alternative Placement

While a student is on expulsion status or under a Critical Behavior Contract, the Director coordinates:

- Temporary remote instruction access
- Continued Aspire services if applicable
- Parent communication schedule
- Re-entry plan development (re-entry meeting required before return)

Part Eight: Special Populations

8.1 McKinney-Vento (Students Experiencing Homelessness)

Federal Requirement: The McKinney-Vento Act requires that students experiencing homelessness have immediate enrollment, access to services, and transportation support. The school must remove barriers — not create them.

Who Qualifies: Students who lack a fixed, regular, and adequate nighttime residence — including those sharing housing due to economic hardship, in shelters, motels, cars, or transitional housing.

Primary Contact: Natalia Ramos (District McKinney-Vento Liaison) — nramos@matchbooklearning.com

Identification Triggers (staff should flag):

- Student mentions housing instability, moving frequently, or staying with relatives
- Attendance patterns show sudden disruption
- Student lacks required enrollment documents
- Front office registration reveals transient housing

Building-Level Protocol:

1. Any staff member who suspects a student qualifies → notify Director and School Social Worker (Katie Nelson) within 24 hours
2. Social Worker conducts initial assessment and documents status in PowerSchool
3. Notify District Liaison (Natalia Ramos) via Google Form — response time is within 24–48 hours
4. Coordinate transportation with Natalia Ramos immediately — do not delay enrollment
5. Connect family to resources via Family Services Coordinator (Mr. Ornelas): 211 Directory, Trustees Office, shelter providers
6. Log all McKinney-Vento support in PowerSchool
7. Schedule follow-up within 2 weeks to reassess stability

Communication Workflow:

- Google Form → Natalia Ramos + Katie Nelson + Mr. Ornelas + Director
- Response expectation: within 24–48 hours
- Monthly community resource event available to families

Quarterly McKinney-Vento Meeting Agenda Topics:

- Role clarification updates (Liaison / Social Worker / Family Services Coordinator)
- Recent case reviews (no names — process review)
- Communication workflow check
- Transportation coordination review
- Community resource updates
- Action items with owners and dates

8.2 Foster Care

Primary Contact: Natalia Ramos — nramos@matchbooklearning.com

Purpose: Students in foster care require additional support for educational stability and continuity of services across potential placement changes.

Responsibilities:

- Natalia Ramos leads coordination of Foster Care services
- Director supports with: attendance monitoring, behavioral support, student support meeting participation, community resource coordination, and family/agency communication

Building-Level Protocol:

1. Identify students in foster care at enrollment (front office flags at intake)
2. Notify Natalia Ramos of any new foster care student within 48 hours
3. Ensure records transfer is expedited — do not delay enrollment for missing documents
4. Schedule a support meeting within the first 2 weeks of enrollment
5. Monitor attendance closely — flag any concerns immediately to Natalia
6. Coordinate with placing agency and caseworker as needed
7. Document all foster care coordination in PowerSchool

8.3 Aspire Indiana

Primary Contact: Mike Parks — michael.parks@aspireindiana.org

What Aspire Provides: Behavioral planning, mental health counseling, and intensive student support for Tier 3 students.

Referral Process:

1. Student is placed in Tier 3 and has not responded adequately to school-based intensive supports
2. Director and counselor collaboratively determine an Aspire referral is warranted
3. Parent consent obtained before referral
4. Referral submitted to Mike Parks with relevant documentation
5. Aspire counselor integrated into student support meetings and DBRC monitoring
6. Collaboration meetings held on a schedule determined by need (minimum monthly for active Aspire students)
7. All Aspire-related communication documented in PowerSchool

Part Nine: Missing and Withdrawn Students

9.1 Missing Student Protocol

Immediate Steps (if a student is unaccounted for during school hours):

1. Notify Head of School and front office immediately
2. Initiate in-building sweep — assign staff to check all designated areas
3. If not located within 10 minutes → call IPS Police and parent/guardian simultaneously
4. Head of School leads communication with IPS Police from that point
5. Director maintains documentation log: time reported missing, steps taken, time located or law enforcement notified
6. Document full incident in PowerSchool within 24 hours
7. Review circumstances and update safety procedures if a gap is identified

IDOE Protocol Note: The September 2025 IDOE memo establishes specific procedures for reporting missing students — review this memo annually and ensure compliance.

9.2 Intent to Withdraw / Withdrawal Protocol

1. Parent or guardian contacts school to withdraw student
2. Front office routes withdrawal request to Director within 24 hours
3. Director ensures Intent to Withdraw Form is completed
4. Confirm enrollment destination — is the family enrolling in another school, homeschooling, or unaccounted for?
5. If homeschooling: provide Homeschool FAQ and ensure Exit Attestation is completed per Indiana requirements
6. If no confirmed enrollment destination: flag for follow-up within 5 school days
7. Document withdrawal in PowerSchool with destination noted

8. Confirm records transfer is completed within required timeline

If a student is withdrawn but destination is unknown or unconfirmed:

- Attempt parent/guardian contact via phone, email, and ParentSquare
- If no contact within 5 school days → escalate to Head of School
- Document all outreach attempts in PowerSchool

Part Ten: Community Partnerships and Family Engagement

10.1 Community Partner Quick Reference

Partner	Primary Function	Contact
Aspire Indiana	Behavioral planning, mental health counseling (Tier 3)	Mike Parks — michael.parks@aspireindiana.org
Foster Care	Educational stability coordination	Natalia Ramos — nramos@matchbooklearning.com
McKinney-Vento	Homeless student identification, services, transportation	Natalia Ramos — nramos@matchbooklearning.com
DCS	Child abuse/neglect reporting (school counselor-led)	School Counselors — internal process
IPS Police	Safety threats, criminal allegations, emergency response	Assigned officer — school contact list
211 Indiana	Community resource directory for families	211 or 211indiana.org
Trustees Office	Emergency financial assistance for families	Mr. Ornelas coordinates

Goal of Community Partnerships: Ensure students and families receive coordinated support that promotes attendance, behavioral success, social-emotional wellness, educational access, and long-term success. Partnerships strengthen — they do not replace — school-based supports.

10.2 Community Resource Night

- Frequency: Monthly (goal established in McKinney-Vento meeting)
- Lead: Director + Family Services Coordinator (Mr. Ornelas)
- Format: Open to all families; community partners represented; resources available for housing, food, health, legal aid, and academic support
- Documentation: Attendance log, resource handouts distributed, follow-up needs flagged

10.3 Family Engagement Communication Standards

- ParentSquare is the primary platform for all school-to-home communications
- All significant communications (meetings, concerns, interventions, incidents) must be documented in PowerSchool within 24 hours
- Tone: warm, direct, solutions-oriented — never punitive or deficit-focused

- When families are unresponsive: escalate outreach method (call → ParentSquare → email → home visit) and document each attempt

Part Eleven: Documentation Standards

11.1 The Non-Negotiable: If It Is Not Documented, It Did Not Happen

PowerSchool is the official system of record for all significant student interactions, interventions, meetings, and communications. Documentation is not bureaucracy — it is the evidence of care.

11.2 Documentation Standards

All entries must be:

- **Accurate** — reflects what actually happened
- **Objective** — describes observable behavior and actions taken
- **Timely** — entered within 24 hours of the event
- **Professional** — appropriate for any audience, including parents and legal review
- **Student-focused** — centers the student's needs and the school's response

Documentation must include:

- Observable behavior (what happened, specifically)
- Actions taken (by whom, when, in what sequence)
- Communication provided (to whom, how, when)
- Intervention efforts and rationale
- Outcomes and next steps

Documentation must never include:

- Personal opinions or assumptions
- Emotional language
- Labels, diagnoses, or assessments outside your role
- Speculation about family situations

11.3 Documentation Timeline

Event Type	Documentation Deadline
Parent meetings	Within 24 hours
Attendance meetings	Within 24 hours
Behavior/student support meetings	Within 24 hours
Home visits	Within 24 hours

Event Type	Documentation Deadline
Threat assessments	Within 24 hours
Safety concerns	Same day when possible; 24 hours maximum
DCS communication	Within 24 hours
Behavior contracts	Same day — signed copy retained
Title IX events	Same day

11.4 Documentation by Domain

Attendance: Document all meetings, Attendance Success Agreements, home visit outcomes, parent communication, intervention plans, and any DCS-related attendance concerns.

Behavior: Document all Behavior Support Plan meetings, Behavior Contract meetings, Critical Behavior Contract meetings, parent conferences, Tier III intervention meetings, re-entry support meetings, and restorative follow-up.

Wellness and Safety: Document all safety plan meetings, threat assessment follow-up, student support meetings, crisis response actions, and parent communication. Confidential information shared only per school procedure.

Part Twelve: Annual Calendar and System Maintenance

12.1 Start of Year (July–August)

- [] Review and update this playbook — confirm all contacts and links are current
- [] Confirm community partner contacts (Aspire, Natalia Ramos, Aspire, IPS Police)
- [] Update Emergent Tree DBRC platform for new year (contact Megan Flynn)
- [] Set up Tier 2 and Tier 3 Dashboard trackers
- [] Train Dean, counselors, and mentors on MTSS framework and DBRC procedures
- [] Schedule recurring weekly culture meetings
- [] Confirm Title IX documentation folder is organized and accessible
- [] Set quarterly McKinney-Vento meeting dates
- [] Establish community resource night schedule (monthly)
- [] Review attendance tracking system with front office and attendance clerk
- [] Confirm DCS reporting protocol with all counselors

12.2 Fall Semester

- [] Universal Behavior Screener administered in September
- [] Review screener data with MTSS team within 2 weeks of administration
- [] Initiate Tier 2 placements as needed based on screener + early data
- [] First quarterly McKinney-Vento meeting (October)
- [] Title IX compliance check (monthly tracker review)

12.3 Winter/Spring Semester

- [] Universal Behavior Screener administered in January
- [] Review mid-year data; adjust tier placements
- [] Second and third quarterly McKinney-Vento meetings
- [] Expulsion coordination (if applicable) — partnership with Options and remote instruction
- [] Annual DCS reporting review

12.4 End of Year (May–June)

- [] Review all open MTSS cases — document status and transition plans
- [] Complete end-of-year documentation audit in PowerSchool
- [] Review all active Safety Plans — close completed, transition ongoing
- [] Archive Title IX records per retention policy
- [] Update community partner contacts list
- [] Complete this playbook's annual review and revision
- [] Prepare transition documentation for any incoming personnel

Appendix A: Quick Reference — Who to Call

Situation	First Call
Student in immediate danger	911 → IPS Police → Head of School
Suicide ideation / self-harm	School Counselor → Director → Parent
Threat assessment needed	Director + Counselor (same day)
DCS concern	School Counselor (leads report)
McKinney-Vento identification	Social Worker (Katie Nelson) → Natalia Ramos within 24 hrs
Foster Care concern	Natalia Ramos → Director
Aspire referral	Director → Mike Parks
Behavior escalation (classroom)	Dean → Director if Tier 3 level

Situation	First Call
Title IX complaint	Director (Coordinator) → Head of School
Student missing on campus	Head of School + IPS Police (10 min rule)
Family in crisis / resource need	Mr. Ornelas + 211 + Director

Appendix B: Key Documents Checklist

The following documents should be maintained in your active system at all times:

- ☐ MTSS Tier 1 Behavior Checklist template
- ☐ DBRC form templates (Tier 2 and Tier 3)
- ☐ Behavior Contract template
- ☐ Critical Behavior Contract template
- ☐ Attendance Success Agreement template
- ☐ Threat Assessment documentation form
- ☐ Safety Plan template
- ☐ Title IX Investigation Report template
- ☐ Title IX Outcome Letter templates
- ☐ Intent to Withdraw Form
- ☐ Exit Attestation Form (Homeschool)
- ☐ McKinney-Vento referral Google Form link
- ☐ Community Resource Guide (211 + local resources)
- ☐ Emergent Tree DBRC platform login and access
- ☐ Tier 2 Data Dashboard link
- ☐ Tier 3 Data Dashboard link
- ☐ PowerSchool documentation access

Appendix C: Glossary

Term	Definition
BSP	Behavior Support Plan — individualized, documented plan for Tier 3 behavioral intervention
BIP	Behavior Intervention Plan — formal plan typically linked to special education services
DBRC	Daily Behavior Report Card — evidence-based progress monitoring tool for Tier 2/3 students
DCS	Department of Child Services — Indiana state agency for abuse/neglect reporting
FBA	Functional Behavior Assessment — structured analysis of behavior's function; precedes BIP
ISS	In-School Suspension — time-limited removal from general population within the school building

Term	Definition
MDR	Manifestation Determination Review — IEP team meeting to determine if behavior is a function of disability before exclusionary action
McKinney-Vento	Federal law protecting the educational rights of students experiencing homelessness
MTSS	Multi-Tiered Systems of Support — three-tier framework for academic, behavioral, and social-emotional intervention
OSS	Out-of-School Suspension — removal from school building for a defined period
ParentSquare	Primary school-to-home communication platform
PowerSchool	Official student information system and documentation platform
Title IX	Federal law prohibiting sex-based discrimination in education programs

Matchbook Learning — Culture & Student Support Playbook | Version 1.0 | June 2026
Review annually. Update contacts, links, and protocols each July.